

One Goldman Sachs In Practice

What the strategy looks like when it's actually happening · how it differs from "One BlackRock" and Morgan Stanley's "Integrated Firm" · and what it means inside the Client Solutions team, day to day

Companion to the full One GS report (doc 21 — the anatomy). This one is the practice. Labels: **OFFICIAL** **CORROBORATED**
ANECDOTAL **INFERRED** **TRANSCRIPT** · 16 Aug 2026

Thirty-second recap, then we go concrete. One Goldman Sachs = the client belongs to the firm, not to a division: one coordinated view of every client, the whole shelf delivered as a single offer. It exists because clients consolidated their buying, silos competed internally, and shareholders pay more for durable, cross-sold revenue. That's the theory (doc 21). **This document answers: what would you actually SEE?**

1. What One GS looks like in practice — ten observable things

Where you'd see it	What actually happens
1. The org chart itself OFFICIAL	2022: four divisions collapsed into three segments — banking and trading merged into one Global Banking & Markets; asset and wealth management merged into AWM. Walls were literally deleted from the reporting structure. 2025: Capital Solutions Group created to fuse financing, origination and structuring across old borders.
2. One client group for the alternatives shelf TRANSCRIPT	Ahmed's own description: instead of several GS teams separately phoning the same sovereign wealth fund, <i>"a centralised client group presents the whole alternatives shelf and helps allocators choose exposures, with strategy specialists behind it."</i> One call instead of five. This IS the client-solutions model — you heard the strategy's flagship mechanism described by a partner.
3. The OCIO mandates OFFICIAL	Delivering BAE or Verizon requires public investing + privates + hedging + manager research + execution + reporting simultaneously — multiple teams performing as one for one client, contractually. Every OCIO win is One GS with a signature on it.
4. The founder loop INFERRED, standard	IB floats a founder's company; the newly wealthy founder becomes a Private Wealth client; years later their next venture borrows from GS or their family office invests in GS alternatives. One client, four revenue lines, decades.
5. The Verizon double-scope OFFICIAL	July 2026: one announcement covering Verizon's DB pension (managed) AND its \$40bn 401(k) plan (advised) — two different services, one relationship conversation. A siloed firm signs those separately or not at all.
6. One research department TRANSCRIPT	Jessica's ~35,000 client interactions a year serve trading clients, banking relationships (via chaperoned walls) and AM investors alike. Jack's best ideas "come from Jess's team." One clearinghouse, every division drinking from it.
7. Compensation & the partner class CORROBORATED	Pay and partner elections increasingly reward "delivering the firm" — cross-divisional referrals and firmwide outcomes — not just a desk's own P&L. Culture follows comp; this is the enforcement layer most slogans lack.
8. Careers that cross the firm TRANSCRIPT	Jessica: five or six different jobs across two continents. Jack: derivatives → cash → UK sales leadership. Ahmed: banking → investing. Internal mobility is the strategy expressed as biographies.
9. Jack's future-founder pipeline TRANSCRIPT	He introduces clients who dream of launching funds to prime brokerage "five or six years before launch" — seeding tomorrow's firmwide client today, with zero immediate revenue. Long-term greedy, operationalised.
10. Even the recruiting system OFFICIAL	One candidate record, one email identity, a 4-application cap across ALL divisions — the firm literally processes you as one applicant to one firm, not four applicants to four departments. You've experienced One GS already; it screened you.

2. What it showcases — the client's-eye view

- **One phone call.** A CIO with a complex problem calls one covering person and the whole shelf mobilises behind that person — instead of the client project-managing five bankers.
- **Answers at the speed of one firm.** "Can you hedge it, finance it, and manage the residual?" gets one coherent answer, not three referrals.
- **Nothing falls in the seams.** The hand-off moments — where your Pictet experience taught you trust lives — are internalised. The client never meets the seam.
- **Proof it's real, not marketing:** clients are voting with the largest transfers in the industry — £23bn, \$43bn, \$70bn — and with their own staff (the lift-outs). You don't hand your team to a slogan. **OFFICIAL mandates** **INFERRED reading**

3. "One Goldman" vs "One BlackRock" vs the "Integrated Firm" — everyone claims it; here's what differs

Fair warning: every large firm claims integration. The differences are in **what is being integrated, what enforces it, and whether the clients overlap enough for it to matter.**

Firm & slogan	What's actually being integrated	The unifier / enforcement	The honest assessment
Goldman — "One Goldman Sachs" OFFICIAL	Maximum business diversity: advice (M&A #1 for 23 years), markets, investing, wealth — genuinely different crafts — over maximum client overlap (post-Marcus, the whole firm serves the same institutional/corporate/wealthy universe).	Org redesign (2022 mergers), centralised client coverage, comp and partner criteria, CEO-named strategy.	The hardest version to execute and the most valuable when it works: the most <i>different</i> capabilities delivered to the most <i>shared</i> clients. Its edge is that the client graphs genuinely overlap; a pension fund can consume all four businesses.
BlackRock — "One BlackRock" CORROBORATED (long-standing stated principle)	One <i>culture and platform</i> across what is ultimately one business : asset management at \$14tn scale.	Aladdin — a single technology spine running risk and portfolios for the whole firm (and sold to rivals, including powering Morgan Stanley's risk platform).	Real and formidable — but it's integration <i>within</i> a product universe, not <i>across</i> business types. BlackRock has no M&A bench or trading floor to conduct. Different game: platform uniformity vs capability orchestration.
Morgan Stanley — "The Integrated Firm" OFFICIAL (Ted Pick's named strategy)	Investment bank ↔ the giant wealth franchise (\$6.5tn client assets): bankers' corporate clients become wealth clients; wealth feeds IM.	CEO mandate; the wealth flywheel; advisor referral machinery.	The closest philosophical cousin — but wealth-led: the integration's centre of gravity is the advisor channel. GS's centre of gravity is the institutional client. Both coherent; different spines.
J.P. Morgan (no single equivalent slogan)	Everything — consumer (Chase's ~80m customers), payments, custody, CIB, AM.	Scale and the fortress balance sheet.	The broadest firm — but the client graphs barely overlap end-to-end: a checking-account customer will never buy an OCIO. Integration is strong <i>within</i> the institutional bank, incoherent <i>across</i> the whole. Breadth is JPM's strength; oneness isn't. INFERRED from structures

The distilled formula (yours to deploy): the value of a "one firm" strategy = **diversity of capabilities × overlap of clients × strength of enforcement**. BlackRock maxes enforcement but has one capability. JPM maxes diversity but client overlap collapses across consumer/institutional. Morgan Stanley integrates two poles through

one channel. **Goldman is the only firm scoring high on all three** — which is why its version, hardest to run, is worth the most when it works. Say that in an interview and you've said something about strategy, not slogans.

4. The business-model meaning — the ground under your first paragraph

You want P1 of your letter to be your journey: listening to the private credit partner, linking to One GS. Here is the understanding that makes that paragraph unshakeable under questioning — One GS is three strategies wearing one name:

1. **A revenue strategy: share of wallet.** Winning a bigger slice of each existing client is cheaper than winning new clients. One coordinated coverage view is the machine for that.
2. **A valuation strategy: durable fees.** The market pays more for recurring revenue; recurring revenue lives in AWM; AWM's growth runs on clients passed across and kept for decades. One GS is how the cheap-multiple firm becomes the expensive-multiple firm.
3. **An organisational strategy: design plus incentives.** Merged segments, centralised client groups, comp that rewards delivering the firm. Not a poster — plumbing.

And the honest link to Ahmed (for your paragraph, in your words): what you heard at that session was not a slogan — it was the plumbing: once-competing pockets consolidated so "a client meets one firm"; balance-sheet bets converted to client capital that scales; one centralised group presenting the whole shelf to allocators. In other words, you watched a partner describe *the mechanism* of One Goldman Sachs, in the division you're applying to, before you knew the strategy's name. That sequence — heard the mechanism, later found the name, then understood the business model behind it — is a genuine journey, and it's yours.

5. One GS inside the Client Solutions team — workflows, goals, and why you'd want the mindset

The day-to-day workflows where One GS literally shows up

BEST GUESS — standard practice for the seat; verify with the team

Workflow	The One-GS moment inside it
An RFP response	You assemble answers from portfolio managers, risk, operations, legal and performance teams into one coherent document — you are literally binding the firm into a single voice for one client.
A quarterly portfolio review	The pack pulls investment performance, research views, market context, sometimes strats analytics — the client sees one narrative built from five departments.
A prospect meeting brief	Before an RM walks in: what does the whole firm know about this client? Existing mandates, related relationships, relevant research — the coordinated client view, on one page, made by you.
Presenting the alternatives shelf	Ahmed's centralised model in action: one team framing private credit, PE and real assets side-by-side so an allocator can choose — instead of three separate pitches.
An onboarding or service escalation	You chase custodians, ops, legal and the investing team so the client experiences one firm, not a relay — your Pictet muscle, inside the integrated design.
A cross-firm referral landing	A GBM coverage banker's corporate contact wants to discuss its pension: the intake, triage and follow-through of that hand-off runs through the client group. This is where "delivering the firm" changes teams.

The team's goals — what the scoreboard says **BEST GUESS** on exact metrics

- **Net flows** (money in minus money out) — the number the CEO's strategy stands on;
- **Retention** — every kept mandate is compounding fee revenue;
- **Breadth** — strategies per client (the cross-sell measure; One GS's own KPI in miniature);
- **Pipeline health** — RFPs live, finals reached, consultant ratings maintained.

Why you'd want to work with a One-GS mindset — the honest cases

- **It's the whole job of your seat.** In most teams One GS is a value to remember; in Client Solutions it is the workflow itself — the role exists to be the coordination. If the philosophy attracts you, this is its native habitat.
- **Your learning surface multiplies.** Conducting specialists means constant contact with investing teams, research, strats, ops — a junior in a coordinating seat learns the map of the firm years before peers locked in silos.
- **Your network compounds by design.** Every workflow above builds relationships across departments — and at a firm where careers cross divisions (Jessica, Jack, Ahmed), that internal graph IS career capital. **TRANSCRIPT**
- **It matches how you already work.** The portal that routed DDQs across 20 teams; the onboarding that made several departments feel like one firm to a client — your instinct is coordination. One GS is that instinct as corporate strategy.

Three traps when you talk about One GS — avoid them and you'll sound like an insider: (1) never present it as "no walls" — information barriers are real and legally required (research/banking chaperones; the secondaries wall); it's coordination *within* compliance. (2) Never say AM is subsidised by the bank — doc 21 has the precise truth. (3) Never cite One GS as culture-fluff — always attach it to a mechanism (the 2022 reorg, the centralised client group, an OCIO mandate). Slogan + mechanism = understanding; slogan alone = every other candidate.

Sources. GS reorg, Capital Solutions, OCIO mandates, Verizon dual-scope, recruiting mechanics: GS official materials and this project's verified research (docs 11–16, 21). Ahmed/Jessica/Jack material: your event transcript. "One BlackRock": BlackRock's long-stated principle **CORROBORATED from general record**; Aladdin's role incl. powering Morgan Stanley's risk platform: BlackRock/Aladdin publications. "The Integrated Firm": Morgan Stanley's own strategic updates under Ted Pick **OFFICIAL**. JPM assessment: inferred from public structure, labelled. CSG workflow and metric detail: informed judgement about standard practice — verify with the team, which is itself a strong interview question ("how does the team measure success?"). Re-verify numbers before quoting.